

FORENSIC SEARCH AND TECHNICAL REVIEW

Current Forensic SEO Audit

Evidence-based findings from the current repository, live production site, sitemap crawl, regression checks, and deployment response headers.

Audit date: September 2, 2026

Production: <https://eternallifehospice.com>

Branch: main **Commit:** ee466b6c

Audit mode: Read-only. No application, deployment, configuration, asset, secret, or external-system changes were made.

Executive summary

The current site has a strong technical SEO foundation, but three production issues deserve priority: the Care Brief redirect loop, failed HTTPS on the www hostname, and disabled caching/compression for static responses.

177

unique sitemap URLs

176

sitemap URLs returning HTTP 200

145

city pages passing specialized checks

606

coverage assertions passing

0

production dependency vulnerabilities

3

high-priority findings

Top priorities

1. **Fix the Care Brief loop.** `/care-brief` is in the sitemap and `llms.txt`, but alternates between `/care-brief` and `/care-brief/` with 301 redirects.
2. **Repair the www certificate/domain configuration.** `https://www.eternallifehospice.com` fails TLS, while HTTP sends users to that failing HTTPS hostname.
3. **Restore production caching and compression.** Sampled HTML, CSS, JavaScript, JSON, and image responses return `Cache-Control: no-store`; no gzip or Brotli encoding was observed.

Other findings are primarily indexation governance for internal artifact pages, missing image dimensions, security-header deployment consistency, fallback Netlify configuration ambiguity, and small social metadata gaps.

Verified baseline

Item	Current result
Branch	main
Current commit	ee466b6cf120471ff9868ef52f1562f7c472c2aa
Local working tree	Clean
Raw HTML files	199
Sitemap URLs	177 unique URLs
Production robots.txt	HTTP 200, valid plain text
Production sitemap.xml	HTTP 200, valid XML
Production /health	HTTP 200, ok
Production /healthz	HTTP 404
Sitemap crawl	176 HTTP 200 pages; one redirect-loop failure
Published city pages	145
npm production vulnerabilities	0

Deployment parity: production HTML differs from local HTML only by a Replit-injected analytics script immediately before </body>. First-party JavaScript assets sampled from production matched the repository byte-for-byte.

Findings register

ELH-F-001 — Care Brief redirect loop

HIGH

Category: Crawlability, redirects, sitemap and AI readiness **Status:** Confirmed

Affected URL: <https://eternallifehospice.com/care-brief>

Evidence:

```
/care-brief → 301 Location: /care-brief/  
/care-brief/ → 301 Location: /care-brief
```

The URL is included in `sitemap.xml`, main navigation, footer navigation, breadcrumb schema, internal links, and `llms.txt`. The direct file `/care-brief.html` returns HTTP 200.

Impact: Google and AI crawlers cannot reach the Care Brief archive through the intended canonical route, and users can encounter a redirect error.

Recommended fix: Make `/care-brief` the one canonical HTTP 200 route. Redirect `/care-brief/` to it in one hop, and keep `sitemap`, `canonical`, `navigation`, `schema`, and `llms.txt` aligned.

Aesthetic impact: None expected. Technical approval only.

ELH-F-002 — HTTPS www hostname fails TLS

HIGH

Category: Canonical domain, crawlability and deployment **Status:** Confirmed

Evidence: Three independent HTTPS attempts to <https://www.eternallifehospice.com/> failed with a TLS “unexpected EOF” error and HTTP status 000.

HTTP currently responds with:

```
http://www.eternallifehospice.com/  
→ 301 Location: https://www.eternallifehospice.com:443/
```

Impact: Visitors, crawlers, old bookmarks, listings, and backlinks using the `www` hostname can fail before reaching the canonical site.

Recommended fix: Confirm the `www` custom domain and certificate in the active Replit deployment. Configure a direct 301 from `www HTTPS` to the non-`www` canonical domain, preserving path and query string.

Aesthetic impact: None. Requires domain/DNS and deployment access.

ELH-F-003 — Production disables browser caching

HIGH

Category: Performance and deployment **Status:** Confirmed

Production returned `Cache-Control: no-store` for sampled homepage HTML, CSS, JavaScript, JSON, and image responses. The active Python server applies `no-store` whenever a response does not already have another cache policy. The Netlify `_headers` file is not automatically applied by the Replit Python server.

Sampled assets included:

- Homepage HTML: approximately 247 KB
- Shared CSS: approximately 60 KB
- Header JavaScript: approximately 13 KB
- Search index JSON: approximately 71 KB
- Somis JPEG: approximately 8.87 MB

Impact: Repeat visits redownload or revalidate assets unnecessarily, increasing bandwidth and mobile load time.

Recommended fix: Add endpoint-specific caching in the active Replit server. Use short revalidation for HTML and longer public caching for versioned static assets.

Aesthetic impact: None if implemented as HTTP headers only.

ELH-F-004 — No observed production compression

HIGH

Category: Performance **Status:** Confirmed for sampled responses

Requests sent with compression support did not receive `Content-Encoding: gzip` OR `Content-Encoding: br`.

Impact: Larger text transfers and slower first visits on mobile networks.

Recommended fix: Enable Brotli or gzip for HTML, CSS, JavaScript, JSON, XML, and SVG. Do not recompress JPEG, PNG, WebP, PDF, or other already-compressed formats.

Aesthetic impact: None. Technical approval only.

Additional findings

ELH-F-005 — Public utility/artifact HTML lacks indexation controls

MEDIUM

Status: Confirmed; indexing intent requires a decision

Fourteen internal social/gallery artifact pages are publicly crawlable, absent from the sitemap, and do not contain `noindex`. `/referral-card` is also omitted from the sitemap but is not marked `noindex`.

Examples include:

- `/assets/img/amethyst-tmp/gallery`
- `/assets/social/elh-social-brand-brief`
- `/assets/social/mosaic-m1`
- `/assets/social/mosaic-m3`
- `/assets/social/mosaic-m5`
- `/assets/social/mosaic-m7`
- `/assets/social/mosaic-m9`
- `/assets/social/mosaic-pinterest`
- `/assets/social/stillness-card`
- `/referral-card`

Impact: Search engines may discover low-value internal design artifacts and spend crawl attention on them.

Recommended fix: Decide which routes are intentionally public. For internal-only tools, remove them from deployment or add `noindex`, `nofollow`. Do not add full SEO metadata solely to satisfy an audit score.

Approval: Business/brand decision required for `/referral-card`.

ELH-F-006 — Missing explicit image dimensions

MEDIUM

Category: Performance and layout stability **Status:** Confirmed

Across the 177 sitemap pages, 631 image occurrences lack either an explicit width or height.

Impact: The browser may not reserve image space before loading, creating layout-shift risk under slower network conditions. The prior Lighthouse baseline showed CLS 0, so this is preventive rather than proof of a current field CLS failure.

Recommended fix: Add accurate intrinsic dimensions while preserving responsive CSS such as `max-width:100%; height:auto;`. Verify mobile, tablet, and desktop screenshots before release.

Aesthetic impact: Possible if dimensions are inaccurate. Visual regression testing required.

ELH-F-007 — Image loading strategy is not explicit on many images

LOW-MED

Status: Confirmed inventory; not every occurrence is a defect

Across sitemap pages, 355 image occurrences have neither loading nor fetchpriority. The city-page guard confirms that all 145 city pages have a WebP hero preload and appropriate hero markup.

Recommended fix: Classify images by position: eager/high priority for LCP heroes, default for immediately visible supporting images, and lazy loading for below-the-fold content. Do not lazy-load every image automatically.

ELH-F-008 — Large fallback JPEG inventory

INFO-MED

Status: Confirmed inventory; active transfer risk is mitigated for modern browsers

85 deployable assets exceed 500 KB. Seventy-three city JPEGs exceed 500 KB. The largest are Somis at 8.87 MB and Stevenson Ranch at 8.75 MB.

All 73 large city JPEGs have WebP versions. For example, Somis is approximately 8.87 MB as JPEG versus 92 KB as WebP, a 99% reduction.

Recommended fix: Do not delete or replace approved imagery automatically. Review whether fallback JPEG quality can be reduced while preserving the approved crop and appearance.

Additional findings, continued

ELH-F-009 — Production does not apply repository security headers

MEDIUM

Status: Confirmed

Live sampled HTML included HSTS, but did not include the repository's intended Content-Security-Policy, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy, or frame restrictions.

The Netlify fallback CSP also needs review because it combines `frame-src 'none'` with another frame source and does not clearly cover every active third-party runtime host.

Impact: This is not a direct ranking defect, but it weakens browser security and creates inconsistent behavior between Replit and the frozen Netlify fallback.

Recommended fix: Define appropriate headers in the active Replit server or supported edge, then test chat, forms, UserWay, Metricool, WhatConverts, Clarity, Brevo, and analytics before tightening CSP.

Aesthetic impact: Normally none. Widget behavior must be browser-tested.

ELH-F-010 — Duplicate Netlify build configurations

MEDIUM

Affected files: `netlify.toml` and `website/elh-preview/netlify.toml`

The root configuration uses `website/elh-preview` as its base, strips form-routing attributes, and runs the full predeployment chain. The nested configuration assumes the site directory is the root, regenerates city data and the search index, and invokes a PageSpeed plugin.

Impact: The active Replit deployment is not dependent on these files, but the frozen Netlify fallback could build differently depending on which configuration Netlify treats as authoritative.

Recommended fix: Verify the Netlify project base directory and dashboard build settings before deciding which file is authoritative. Do not change either file blindly.

ELH-F-011 — Alternate Replit hostname serves a duplicate copy

LOW-MED

Affected hostname: `https://eternal-life-hospice.replit.app`

The Replit hostname returns HTTP 200 and body content identical to the canonical hostname. Page canonicals correctly point to `https://eternallifehospice.com`.

Impact: Current canonicals provide duplicate-content protection, but two publicly accessible hostnames create unnecessary crawl surfaces.

Recommended fix: If feasible, redirect normal HTML page requests on the Replit hostname to the canonical domain while preserving required API and proxy routes. Audit the form/chat architecture before redirecting APIs.

ELH-F-012 — Small remaining social metadata gaps

LOW

The article `/blog/the-caregiver-who-needs-care` has an OG image but lacks `og:image:width` and `og:image:height`.

The HTML sitemap page `/sitemap` lacks `twitter:title`, `twitter:description`, and `twitter:image`.

Impact: Possible inconsistency in shared-link previews; no direct indexation impact.

ELH-F-013 — Six descriptions exceed 160 characters

LOW

All sitemap pages have descriptions, and none are empty or duplicated. The following exceed 160 characters:

Route	Length
<code>/hospice-care</code>	187
<code>/about/aleksandra-dubina</code>	252
<code>/resources/pain-symptom-management</code>	193
<code>/resources/volunteer</code>	161
<code>/services</code>	188
<code>/care-brief</code>	201

Google may truncate or rewrite these descriptions. This is not itself a ranking defect.

Additional findings, continued

ELH-F-014 — Address formatting is not uniform

LOW-MED

Status: Confirmed

Both Ste. 325B and Suite 325B appear. Observed source counts were 37 occurrences of the approved abbreviated form and 157 occurrences of the longer form across 151 files.

Both formats identify the same suite and are unlikely to create a major local SEO issue, but strict NAP consistency is preferable.

Recommended fix: Confirm the preferred postal format against the Google Business Profile, then use it consistently in visible contact information, Organization schema, city-page schema, and directory listings.

Approval: Brand and Google Business Profile confirmation required.

ELH-F-015 — Missing automated SEO guard scripts

MEDIUM

The project has a passing structured-data guard, but these planned guards are absent:

```
website/check-og-metadata.py
website/check-img-alt.py
website/check-sitemap.py
```

Impact: Current predeployment checks would not automatically block the missing OG dimensions or the live Care Brief redirect loop.

Recommended fix: Add route-aware checks for sitemap resolution, noindex/sitemap conflicts, required social metadata, image alt attributes, canonical/sitemap consistency, and redirect loops.

ELH-F-016 — Form endpoint uses 404 for unsupported GET

LOW

GET /api/form-submit returns HTTP 404. Valid forms use POST, and the source handler includes same-origin enforcement, global and client rate limits, body-size limits, form parsing, delivery error handling, and no request-body logging.

This does not prove form submission is broken. A 405 Method Not Allowed response with Allow: POST would be more semantically precise.

A real production submission was not attempted because it could send emails, trigger webhooks, or mutate an external system.

ELH-F-017 — Replit injects an additional production script

INFO

Production HTML contains a Replit-injected script from `i.replit.com` immediately before `</body>`. This is the only observed HTML difference from the repository samples. First-party JavaScript assets matched byte-for-byte.

No change is recommended without confirming the feature that controls the script and its performance/privacy behavior.

CONTROLS THAT PASSED

Healthy areas

Structure and sitemap: robots.txt and sitemap.xml are valid; 177 unique canonical-domain URLs are listed; all successful sitemap pages have titles and self-consistent canonicals.

Titles, descriptions and headings: zero missing titles, zero duplicate titles, zero titles over 65 characters, zero missing descriptions, zero duplicate descriptions, and every sitemap page has exactly one H1.

Structured data: 653 JSON-LD blocks were inventoried; no malformed JSON-LD was found; the project structured-data regression check passed.

Internal linking: no confirmed broken local HTML routes were found by the static route-aware scan. Header parity passed on all standard pages with 21 documented intentional exceptions.

City pages: all 145 city pages passed the specialized regression check. WebP hero preloads, hero markup, coverage aliases, analytics loading, and deferred-script expectations passed. Current distinctiveness checks did not confirm a blanket doorway-page problem.

Analytics: `/assets/analytics.js` appears on all 177 sitemap pages. Chat appears on 174 pages; the three exclusions are specialized Media Kit/Care Brief reader experiences.

Coverage and chat: 51 server/chat/coverage regression checks passed, along with all 606 coverage lookup assertions.

Dependencies: the read-only production dependency audit reported zero critical, high, moderate, or low vulnerabilities.

Performance observations

A fresh Google PageSpeed request was attempted, but Google returned HTTP 429 because the public API quota was exceeded. A current Lighthouse score was therefore not verifiable in this pass.

The latest previously supplied mobile baseline remains historical context only:

Metric	Historical result
Performance	79
Accessibility	91
Best Practices	100
SEO	100
FCP	2.3 seconds
LCP	4.4 seconds
TBT	0 ms
CLS	0

Current network timing samples

URL	TTFB	Total
Homepage	0.288s	0.358s
Somis city page	0.136s	0.139s
Resources	0.193s	0.225s
Referral page	0.173s	0.174s

AI-search readiness

llms.txt exists, contains 171 internal URLs, and uses an intentional distinction between retrieval/search assistants and training crawlers. Selected answer assistants are allowed, while selected training crawlers are disallowed.

The only broken internal destination found in llms.txt was /care-brief, because of the redirect loop documented above.

Forms and conversion paths

The source contains eight form elements across the principal conversion pages. Active forms post to /api/form-submit. The handler includes:

- Same-origin enforcement

- Global and client rate limiting
- Request-body size limits
- Form and upload parsing
- Delivery error handling
- No request-body logging

Real production submissions were intentionally not performed because they could send emails, trigger webhooks, or mutate external systems. A controlled future test should verify the family request, professional referral, Care Brief signup, careers upload, Brevo delivery, alert webhook, and acknowledgement behavior.

External-link audit limitations

Fifty-five external links were inventoried. Twenty-three non-social-share links were tested:

- 18 returned HTTP 200
- Two CDPH URLs failed local certificate verification
- Two Instagram URLs returned 429/login behavior
- One Yelp short link returned 403 to the automated checker

These results do not prove those links are broken. CDPH, Instagram, and Yelp commonly restrict automated clients and should be verified manually in a normal browser before changing them.

SCOPE BOUNDARIES

Items not verifiable with current access

- Actual Google Search Console coverage and indexing data
- Google-selected canonicals
- “Crawled, currently not indexed” URLs
- Search queries, impressions, and click-through rates
- Manual actions or security reports in Search Console
- Field Core Web Vitals
- Current PageSpeed score, because the API returned HTTP 429
- Backlink quality or toxic-link profile
- Google Business Profile dashboard values
- Netlify dashboard configuration and fallback runtime behavior
- GitHub branch protection and account-level Actions settings
- Deployed secret configuration
- Brevo delivery and alert webhook delivery
- Full axe/WCAG browser audit
- Rich Results Test eligibility

These items should not be treated as passing or failing without the appropriate platform data.

Visual and compliance risk classification

Change class	Examples	Review needed
No expected visual impact	Routing, TLS, compression, caching, security headers, OG/Twitter metadata, noindex, sitemap and regression checks	Technical
Requires visual regression testing	Image dimensions, image loading behavior, JPEG fallback compression, CSS or font delivery	Technical plus visual QA
Requires brand/business approval	Indexation of referral card and internal artifacts; final address format; long-description rewrites	Brand/business
Requires compliance/privacy review	Third-party analytics behavior, CSP changes, medical-benefit or cost wording, form-data handling	Compliance/privacy

IF IMPLEMENTATION IS APPROVED

Recommended remediation order

1. **Priority 0:** Fix the Care Brief redirect loop.
2. **Priority 0:** Repair TLS and canonical redirection for the www hostname.
3. **Priority 0:** Re-crawl all 177 sitemap URLs.
4. **Priority 1:** Implement correct browser caching for static assets.

5. **Priority 1:** Enable Brotli or gzip for text-based responses.
6. **Priority 1:** Apply security headers through the active Replit server or supported edge.
7. **Priority 1:** Run fresh mobile and desktop Lighthouse tests.
8. **Priority 2:** Decide whether internal social/gallery pages should be deployed or marked noindex.
9. **Priority 2:** Decide whether /referral-card should be indexable.
0. **Priority 2:** Ensure the canonical Care Brief route is the only indexable archive URL.
1. **Priority 3:** Add OG image dimensions to the caregiver article and Twitter metadata to the HTML sitemap.
2. **Priority 3:** Review the six long descriptions.
3. **Priority 3:** Standardize Ste. 325B versus Suite 325B after confirming Google Business Profile format.
4. **Priority 4:** Add accurate intrinsic image dimensions and classify eager versus lazy loading.
5. **Priority 4:** Review JPEG fallback compression without changing approved crops.
6. **Priority 4:** Add missing SEO regression guards, including live redirect-loop detection.

Final no-change confirmation: This PDF is a review deliverable only. The application, deployment, configuration, assets, dependencies, secrets, workflows, and external systems were not changed during the audit.